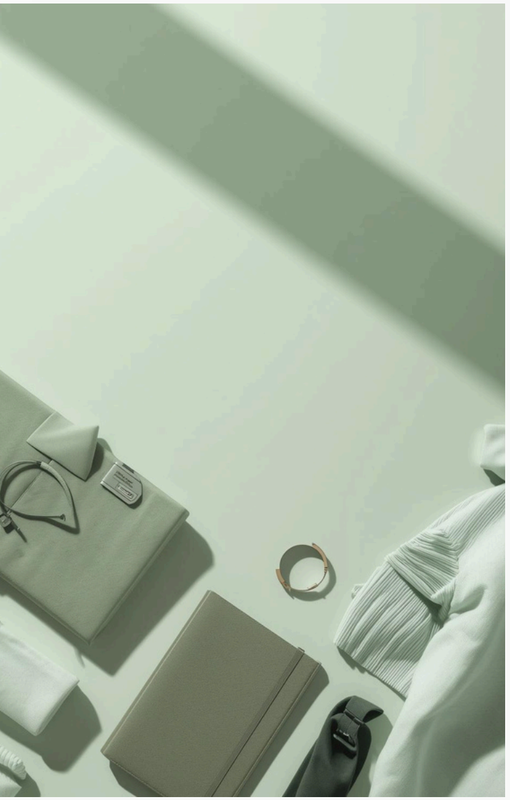
Stage 1: Empathize - 5W1H Framework



Who will view this Dashboard?	What problem does this dashboard solve?	When and where will stakeholders view this dashboard?	Why do stakeholders need this dashboard?	How have stakeholders tried to achieve this goal?
- Senior Leadership & Marketing Directors - Marketing Team / Analysts	- Synthesizes fragmented data between Ads performance and overall OMS sales. - Links marketing spend directly to product sales and profitability per SKU. - Highlights low ROAS campaigns and misaligned ad budget allocation.	**When:** - Before weekly/monthly marketing review meetings. - When budget reallocation decisions are required. - When profit margins fluctuate unexpectedly. **Where:** - At the office. - While on business trips / remote meetings.	- To quickly grasp marketing ROI without manual data mapping. - To make data-driven decisions on budget reallocation. - To react faster to underperforming campaigns (early-stop). - To consolidate and enhance internal communication between Ads and Sales teams.	- Reviewing fragmented reports from Ads platforms (clicks/inboxes). - Reviewing total OMS orders provided by the Sales team. - Doing manual data matching in Excel to cross-reference budget with product SKUs, which is slow and prone to errors.
If only one key stakeholder is chosen, who would it be?	Senior Leadership & Marketing Directors			
Summarize the problem in one sentence	This dashboard helps stakeholders unify ad spend with OMS sales data to identify which campaigns and products generate true profit, enabling precise data-driven budget allocation.			

Empathy Map

What does the stakeholder think and feel?	What does the stakeholder see?	What does the stakeholder say and do?
Thinking: - Thinks about the high marketing costs and the pressure to maintain healthy profit margins. - Doubts whether massive ad traffic actually translates to profitable product sales. **Feeling:** - Confused by unstable net profit margins week over week. - Frustrated by the disconnect between Ads metrics (clicks, inboxes) and real bottom-line revenue. - Concerned about over-reliance on a few "star" campaigns.	- Fragmented reports: Ads team shows Clicks/Inbox; Sales team shows Total OMS numbers. - Dashboard visuals revealing outliers where campaigns are drastically underperforming vs ad spend. - Unclear connection between specific ad campaigns and the SKUs they actually sold. - Data inconsistency between marketing platforms and actual OMS revenue.	- "Why is our marketing spend so high but our profit margin dropping?" - "I need to see exactly which SKUs this campaign is selling, not just the clicks." - Asks staff to combine marketing data and sales data into one clear report. - "We need to stop wasting budget on unprofitable ads."
What are the biggest problems and challenges?	**What are the opportunities and benefits?**	
- No clear overview of true Return on Ad Spend (ROAS) at the SKU level. - High ad revenue on paper, but poor actual profit sustainability due to low tracking of Direct vs Ads profit per item. - Lack of automated performance-driven early-stop rules for failing campaigns. - Too much time spent manually piecing Ads data and OMS data together.	- Quickly identify and halt unprofitable campaigns to save budget. - Make strategic decisions faster by scaling high-profit, high-volume SKUs (e.g. Audrey Shirt, Lisa Dress). - Unify Sales and Marketing alignment with a single source of truth. - Maximize predictability in Net Profit Margins.	

Stage 2: Stakeholders Journey

Step 1

Starting from the company's business situation, Leadership notices that despite spending heavily on cross-channel marketing campaigns, profit margins are erratic. They want to understand the true efficiency and ROI of their marketing budget.

Step 2

To get the needed insights, stakeholders reach out to Data Analysts to build dashboards that link marketing spend directly with Product/SKU sales data from the OMS. From this, they can identify growth opportunities.

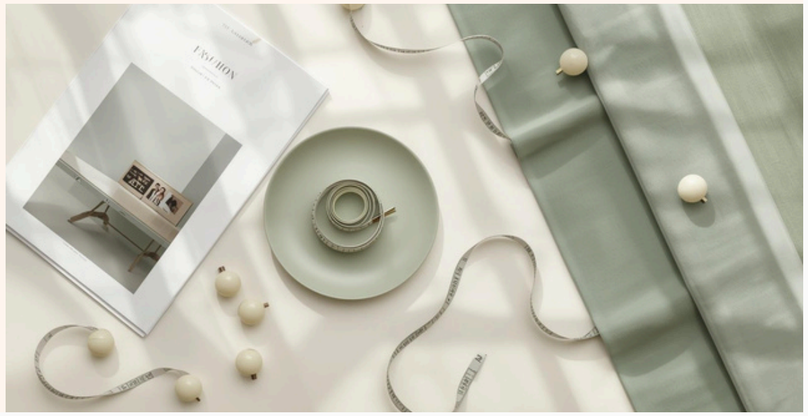
Step 3

After receiving the dashboard, stakeholders find clear answers: tracking profit by day, exposing campaigns "burning budget" with a scatter plot, and comparing Ad vs. Direct profitability on hero products like the (G)Margnet Dress. They group to brainstorm budget reallocations.

Step 4

New automated budget rules are launched (e.g., early-stopping low ROAS ads based on KPIs), ad spend is prioritized towards high-margin products, and performance data is monitored via 4 designated macro tracking pages.

DEFINE POV & NORTHSTAR METRICS



Dimension Data Group:

Group 1	Group 2	Group 3	Group 4
Campaign / Ad Campaign Name, Campaign Status, Ad Group	**Product** Product Category, Pattern, SKU	**Time** Year, Month, Week, Day	**Channel / Traffic** Ads, Direct/Organic

NORTHSTAR 1	NORTHSTAR 2 (Optional)
What VALUE you want to measure? Profit Margin / True Profit	**What VALUE you want to measure?** Marketing ROAS (Return on Ad Spend)
WHEN the value DELIVERY SUCCESS? WWhen the net profit margin stabilizes and grows steadily, overcoming erratic fluctuations across days/weeks.	**WHEN the value DELIVERY SUCCESS?** When revenue generated by an ad significantly and consistently outweighs its cost.
Northstar Metric Name Total Profit	**Northstar Metric Name** Marketing ROAS
WHY do you choose this metric? - High revenue from massive ad traffic doesn't mean much if the selling costs (ads + operations) are too high. - Profit is the ultimate bottom-line goal to ensure business sustainability (factoring in COGS & Spend).	- Directly measures the efficiency of the core marketing budget. - Helps identify exactly which campaigns bring in sustainable cash inflow vs burning cash.

Views & Breakdown Formulas:

View	Description	Why	NORTHSTAR Formula	NORTHSTAR 1 (Profit Margin)	NORTHSTAR 2 (ROAS)
View 1: Marketing Efficiency KPIs	High-level macro view of ROAS, Budgets, and Profit trends.	Assess overall performance of marketing campaigns to understand global budget spend efficiency.	**View 1 Breakdown**	Total Profit = Total Revenue - COGS - Total Ad Spend	Marketing ROAS = Total Revenue from Ads / Total Ad Spend
View 2: Campaign Performance KPIs	Granular Ad metrics (CPM, CTR, Conversions, CPA).	Pinpoint "which campaigns are burning budget with poor results" to execute early-stops.	**View 2 Breakdown**	Cost per Order = Total Ad Spend / Total Orders	Campaign ROAS = Campaign Revenue / Campaign Spend
View 3: Revenue Generating KPIs	Focus on revenue quality and broad sales generation tracking.	Address the illusory ad revenue issue by evaluating sales drivers globally.	**View 3 Breakdown**	Profit Margin by Channel	ROAS by Target Demographic
View 4: Operational + Product-level Drivers	Deep dive into Product SKUs, Profit breakdowns, and budget overspends.	Identify hero products vs. underperformers to align budget with profitable segments.	**View 4 Breakdown**	SKU Profit = (Selling Price - COGS) * Units - Ads Spend	SKU ROAS = Revenue from SKU / Spend allocated to SKU

Stage 3: Ideate – Brainstorming

Start With: Based on the NorthStar Metric, brainstorm breakdown dimensions and relevant insights from different perspectives.

Overview Layer	**Metric 1** Marketing ROAS	**Metric 2** Total Revenue from Ads	**Metric 3** Total Profit	**Metric 4** Total Ad Spend & Total Budget
	Metric 5 Conversion Rate	**Metric 6** Cost per Order	**Metric 7** CTR & CPA	**Metric 8** Impressions & Clicks

Idea Name	Layer 0 dimension	Layer 1 dimension	Layer 2 dimension	Is there anything important we missed?
View 1: Marketing Efficiency KPIs	- Marketing ROAS- Total Ad Spend- Total Revenue from Ads- Total Budget- Total Profit- Cost per Order	- By Time (Week, Day)- By Campaign Strategy	- Time + Campaign- Campaign + Ad Group	Trend lines for ROAS & Profit over Time
View 2: Campaign Performance KPIs	- Impressions, Clicks, CTR- Engagement & Conversion- CPA & Cost per Engagement- Total CPM & CPC	- By Campaign Status- By Campaign Name	- Impression vs Clicks- Ad Spend vs ROAS	Table tracking granular CTR and ROAS per campaign.
View 3: Revenue Generating KPIs	- Total Revenue- Order Volume- Channel Contribution	- By Traffic Channel (Ads vs Direct)- By Customer Type	- Channel + Time- Channel + Customer Type	X
View 4: Operational + Product Drivers	- Total Budget vs Spend Ratio- Total Ads Orders / Revenue- SKU Selling Price & COGS	- By Product Category- By Pattern / Sub-category- By Product SKU	- Category + Channel (Direct vs Ads)- SKU + Spend	Direct vs Ads Profit comparisons for individual SKUs.

Stage 3: Ideate – Structure Idea

Scorecard	*Marketing ROAS*	*Total Profit*	*Total Budget vs Spend*	*Cost per Order*	*Conversions*	*CPA*

Idea Name	Very Important Information	Important Information	Detailed Information
View 1: Marketing Efficiency KPIs	High-level tracking of Marketing ROAS, Total Profit, and Total Revenue From Ads over time.	Trend lines showing ROAS Trend Over Time and Profit by Day (specifically highlighting positive/negative profit days using red/green bars).	Top 10 Best and Worst Campaigns by Ad Revenue and ROAS. Budget vs Actual Spend grouped by Week to prevent mass overspends.
View 2: Campaign Performance KPIs	Scatter plots identifying exact outliers ("Which campaigns are burning budget with poor results?").	Granular tracking of Clicks, Impressions, CTR, CPM, CPA, and Cost per Engagement metrics over the month.	Deep dive table calculating ROAS for each specific campaign (e.g., DELIA SET, FEEDBACK TODAY) to trigger rapid daily stop/start micro-decisions.
View 3: Revenue Generating KPIs	General revenue tracking vs Target Goals.	Comparing if ad-driven sales are actually yielding sustainable profits compared to organic/direct channels long term.	Identifying any illusory ad revenue that inflates top-line numbers without actually contributing meaningfully to bottom-line net profit.
View 4: Operational + Product-level Drivers	Top 10 Best-Selling Products (e.g., Audrey Shirt, Lisa Dress, Margnet Dress).	Revenue contribution by Product Category separated visually into "Direct Sales" vs "Ads Sales".	Deep Product SKU drill-down comparing precise Ads Sales Profit vs Direct Sales Profit by mapping Selling Price and COGS against Ad Spend per item. Identifies campaigns going over budget on Ad Spend.

Stage 4: PROTOTYPE & REVIEW

During Phase 1 of prototype building, evaluate using the following criteria to iterate (Iterate -> Empathize):

Review Area	Quality of Information	Actionable Output
Marketing Efficiency Monitoring	Are the ROAS and Total Profit trends immediately clear week-over-week?	If No: Enhance KPI cards to clearly show last-week (LW) percentage changes in green/red to highlight rapid drops in profit.
Budget Optimization & Early Stops	Can the marketing team instantly spot campaigns "burning budget with poor results"?	If No: Ensure the scatter plot explicitly separates outliers (high spend, low ROAS) from the baseline cluster.
Product-Level Profitability (SKU Strategy)	Is it easy to distinguish whether "Hero Products" like the Audrey Shirt are driven by organic sales or paid ads?	If No: Redesign the Product Drivers panel to explicitly split Revenue and Profit into "Ads Sales" vs. "Direct Sales" columns per SKU.
Data Accuracy & Alignment	Is the "Total Revenue" cleanly aligned with the OMS without inflating numbers via illusory ad revenue?	If No: Conduct a deep dive to cross-check the Conversion Rate and Total Orders metrics against finalized OMS billing data.

*Design Thinking stresses iteration! If the finalized dashboard still doesn't definitively answer *"How efficiently is the marketing budget being spent and which campaigns/SKUs are actually driving our profit?"*, loop back to the Empathize stage to reassess the pain points and refine the core data model mappings.*